



Add custom start-up scripts in Ubuntu

Let's assume you want to add a custom script named *myscript* to the Ubuntu SysV *init* process. Place your script in the */etc/init.d/* directory, and make sure the file permission is 755. Now execute the following command as the root:

```
update-rc.d myscript defaults
```

Note that when you use the *defaults* option, then *update-rc.d* will make links to start the service in run-levels 2, 3, 4 and 5, and to stop the service in run-levels 0, 1 and 6.

To remove the script from the init system:

```
update-rc.d myscript remove
```

This is applicable for Ubuntu and derived distros only.

—*Debapriya Biswas, debapriya.biswas@gmail.com*



whatis and whereis

You can find any apps path by using the *whereis* command as follows:

```
net@net-desktop:~$ whereis pidgin
pidgin: /usr/bin/pidgin /usr/lib/pidgin /usr/share/man/man1/pidgin.1.gz
```

You can find the description of apps using the *whatis* command:

```
net@net-desktop:~$ whatis iptables
iptables (8) - administration tool for IPv4 packet filtering and NAT
```

—*Balachandar K M, balachandarlinks@gmail.com*



Display the system's SMBIOS hardware components

Do you want to know the entire details of each piece of hardware on your computer? Here is the command for it (run with root permissions):

```
dmidecode -t x
```

Replace x by:

- 0 for BIOS
- 1 for system
- 2 for base board
- 3 for chassis
- 4 for processor
- 5 for memory controller
- 6 for memory module
- 7 for cache
- 8 for port connector
- 9 for system slots
- 10 for on board devices

- 11 for OEM strings
- 12 for system configuration options
- For more available options, refer man pages.

—*Mallikarjun, malik.v.arjun@gmail.com*



Extracting a portion of a log file

Sometimes we might need to extract a small portion (100 or 200 lines) of a log file that has thousands (or lakhs) of lines. This happens when we have to send the log in a mail or while reporting a bug. Use the following command to do this:

```
sed -n '/^starttime/,/^endtime/'p' file part
```

For example, if you want to extract the log between 'Jul 12 10:58:26' to 'Jul 12 11:31:05' from */var/log/messages* to *messages.part*, the command would be:

```
sed -n '/^Jul 12 10:58:26/,/^Jul 12 11:31:05/'p \
/var/log/messages > messages.part
```

The "A" character is used to match the time in the beginning of a line. The format of the start time and end time depends on the log file you are working on. This works only if both the start and end times are recorded in the log file.

—*Sree Pratheep, sreepratheep@gmail.com*



Limit the CPU usage of a process

You can use the *cpulimit* command to limit CPU usage of any process or application. You can limit a certain running application, either by its name or by its PID. For example, to restrict the VLC media player to go beyond a 20 per cent CPU usage limit, use the command below:

```
cpulimit -e vlc -i 20
```

We can also use the PID, as follows:

```
cpulimit -p 5319 -i 40
```

To find the process name or PID, use the *ps -d* command.

—*Neeraj Kumar, neeraj.jnumca07@gmail.com*



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